Table S2 Excluded studies and reason for exclusion

	Study	Reason for exclusion
1	Godden et al. 1999 [1]	Included patients who underwent tumor resection without flap reconstruction
2	Moreno and Bonilla-Velez[2]	Compared three different protocols. Two protocol admitted to the ICU for overnight before transfer to the intermediate care and to the general floor at physician discretion.
3	EDWARD et al. 2002 [3]	Although the author stated that some patients were unadmitted to the ICU, but no outcome were reported regarding patients in Non-ICU setting
4	Vimawala et al[4]	Conference poster
5	Morse et al 2019 [5]	All groups admitted to the ICU before transfer to the Non-ICU setting.
6	Yu et al. 2019 [6]	All patients were transferred to the intermediate level care.
7	Mathew et al 2010[7]	Only 7 patients were transferred to the ICU
8	Dautremont et al 2013[8]	Patients in both groups were admitted to the ICU.
9	Bhama et al 2013[9]	Patients were admitted to open or close ICU.
10	Patel et al. 2017 [10]	No clear information about the three-protocols used (ICU, intermediate level, and surgical ward).
11	Al-Dam et al. 2014[11]	No clear information about the two-protocol used (ICU, intermediate level). Flap failure or other outcomes of interest were not reported in both groups.
12	Bertelsen et al. 2020 [12]	Two different protocols were used but, both group were admitted to the ICU for overnight before transfer to the ward.

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